Program Review—Communication Studies (COMS)—2018-19

1. Describe annual progress / changes / events in the program.

2017-18 was the year that the only full time faculty member in the COMS program was on sabbatical leave. While there was a full time leave replacement, the number of offered sections dropped significantly from previous years and only 15 sections were offered for the entire year. This is down from the +/- 22 sections offered per year for the past decade. Further affecting this dramatic decrease is the growing demand placed on COMS to meet the General Education requirements as they enhanced through the GenEd restructuring and the Interstate Passport.

2. Describe progress on assessing SLOs and PLOs for the program.

For SLO assessment, this year (18-19) is deemed the "initialization year" in the SLO manual, so faculty are supposed to work with the SLO committee to create program maps, make any necessary changes to program-level outcomes, and develop their first key assessment (to be implemented next year. Unfortunately, there is no currently-functioning SLO committee.

3. Discuss any support or obstacles encountered by the program.

As noted above, COMS has significantly increased demand without the ability to meet said demand. There exists a very-limited pool of part-time faculty with the necessary education to teach in this field. Currently, we have one PT faculty member who is willing to teach 2-3 sections per year, another who is willing to teach at maximum capacity but is actively looking for a full time position elsewhere, and 2 new people who have recently moved into the area. One is only willing to teach the Mass Media class and one who has no experience teaching at the college level and needs to slowly ramp up. Assuming that all these individuals remain in place we still do not have the capacity to meet the General education requirements, much less support the vibrant major we have developed. Research into student majors determined that COMS has become the most popular, single-subject, academic major.

4. Describe program budgetary needs or implications. (Submit a CQIP if you are requesting a budget allocation that falls outside of regular yearly budget allocations).

COMS faculty pay for themselves—we have the students to fill the seats and we teach a 5-5 load, so we generate a substantial FTES, while our students also have time in their schedules to accomplish 15 units per term. With increased GE demand, we need to ensure students can meet their needs here at COS.

While an additional full time faculty member is always an expense, the increased FTES generated more than covers that expense. Additionally, if students leave campus to complete their education, we lose even more FTES as well as harming our degree-completion numbers.

Furthermore, the new funding formula incentivizes degree completion, especially AA-T degree completion. COMS is a leader in that area as well as being a popular second major, allowing COS to receive double the credit.

Operational Unit Program Review
Continuous Quality Improvement Proposal (CQIP)

Resource: **New Faculty Position**

Operational:

Board Policy? ☐Yes ☐ No Administrative Procedure? ☐ Yes ☐No

Fiscal: ☐ One-time Funds ☒ Ongoing Funding

Issue: Briefly describe the issue.

Mission critical need for one additional full-time COMS faculty member.

Vision/Mission/Institutional Master Plan Alignment: *Address if this proposal is aligned with the College's vision, mission, and/or a strategic goal within the Institutional Master Plan. Usually these proposals have quoted a portion of one or more of areas being aligned with.*

COS provides accessible, flexible, affordable, and innovative education leading to associate degrees, certificates, college transfer, career and technical education….

COS provides:

- Rigorous and comprehensive transfer programs
- General education programs
- Workforce training and certification

Excellence – Our decisions and actions reflect our commitment to accountability, innovation, and learning.

Goal #1: Promote and support educational goal completion for all students.

Goal #2: Sustain institutional health and vitality to meet the needs of the community.

Program Review Objective*: Identify Program Review Objective/Effort if applicable. Background: Describe the background on this issue – where we are at the present time and how we got here.*

The only way to stabilize both the COMS program and COSGE, is to hire a new, FT Communication Studies Faculty Member. This will provide both stabilization while also allowing for growth in COMS majors.

Background: *Describe the background on this issue – where we are at the present time and how we got here.*

For the past decade, the COMS program has become increasingly vigorous as both a GE program and a major. For 2014 through 2017, we averaged 21 sections per year. A deep dive into the numbers shows that we averaged 11 sections a term, with most of those classes enrolled to within 3 of maximum capacity. When only the sections taught by a full time faculty member are included, 78% of the sections were near –to- above capacity. In 2017, the COSGE pattern was amended to ensure that all graduates would have successful completed a COMS course.

Rationale: *Explain the reasoning behind the proposed improvements. Budgetary Impact: Detail any funding impact to the proposed improvements; sometimes this is a reduction in expenses, and sometimes there is increased spending needs to accomplish the improvements (e.g., a capacity issue within a programmatic area). However, sometimes the proposed improvement has no budgetary impact as it is a process or procedure improvement that does not have a financial component to it. Please explain and justify the extent of the impact(s) here.*

Unlike other GenEd areas, there are no other courses that satisfy the general education requirements and there are only a tiny number of individuals who are able to teach the core courses.

Resource Allocation Adjustments (if any): *Like with fiscal impacts, process and procedure improvements can require changes in how resources on campus are allocated; it could be streamlining people's time, or tasks, or workflows, etc. Or the CQIP is addressing capacity issues for a programmatic area; in these circumstances there is likely both a budgetary impact AND resource allocation adjustment. These adjustments are detailed here.*

As this new hire will generate substantial FTES--more than enough to cover salary and benefits, this hire will improve positive cash flow.

Recommendation: *The recommendation is usually to implement the proposed improvement, and this gives a chance to briefly summarize the issue and its positive impact. In matters of budgetary increase requests this is a good place to reiterate and document the justification.*

A new, Full Time, COMS faculty member **must** be hired. Hiring an additional FT Communication Studies Faculty member will mean that our students can complete their GE in a timely fashion and we can continue to offer this most-popular major. If we fail to take this action, a significant number of students will not be able to meet their educational goals. The choice is clear: meet demand and grow FTES or motivate students to get their needs met elsewhere.

Submitted By: _Jayne Turk_____ Date: 12/17/2018_____

Action Taken: _____